

THE CAGE AND THE UNKNOWN

The Abusive Household Logic

The cage operates like an abusive household.

It presents itself as home. As safety. As the place you're supposed to be.

The inside is worse than the outside. The torment is constant. The pain is familiar.

But you stay.

You stay because the outside is unknown.

Why People Stay in the Torment

The cage has rules. Brutal rules. Rules that hurt.

But you know them.

You know when to flinch. You know the pattern. You know how to survive it. You've built your entire identity around navigating the abuse.

The outside—alignment, presence, actually mattering—that's different.

That's unknown.

And the unknown is scarier than the known torment.

The Real Fear

It's not that alignment will hurt more.

It's that alignment will ask you to be something you don't know how to be.

Outside the cage, there's no script. No pattern to follow. No abuse telling you who you are.

You have to discover who you actually are.

And that discovery requires facing the full weight of your own choices. Every moment. Every action. Every consequence.

You can't hide anymore. You can't use the cage as an excuse.

You just have to be here. And matter. And know that you matter.

The Invisible Choice

So you stay in the torment.

Not because you can't leave.

But because leaving requires something harder than enduring abuse: it requires facing yourself.

It requires admitting that you knew the cage was wrong and you're choosing it anyway.

It requires accepting that the pain you feel isn't something happening **to** you—it's something you're choosing because the alternative is more terrifying.

The Straight Answer

This is why people don't change even when they know they should.

This is why they're tormented and they stay tormented.

Not because the cage forces them.

But because the unknown costs more than they're willing to pay.

And admitting that is harder than staying in the abuse.

So they don't say it. They don't face it.

They just endure.

And call it life.

****The way out is the same choice everyone has to make: you're here. this moment is happening. you either show up or you don't.****

****You're here. That's it.****

